The Problem with Native Apps

Building fully native iOS and Android apps is a *lot* of work. They are expensive to build and even more expensive to maintain. Developers have to build every screen three times: once for the web, once for iOS, and once for Android. For small teams, this just isn't viable.

Every new feature or bug fix release also requires a review by the app store teams. At best, this can delay a mission-critical bug fix for 24 hours. But it's not unheard of for reviews to take up to a week or more.

There's also the complexity of maintaining separate codebases. Fully native apps require all of your business logic to be built in Ruby, Swift, *and* Kotlin. Re-implementing the same thing three times almost guarantees inconsistencies.

So, if you're a Rails developer who wants to build mobile apps for both iOS and Android, what are you to do?